

EB-5

Immigration Eb5 · April 26, 2026 · finished April 26, 2026

11 FIRMS	4 SEARCH AXES	4 CROSS-AXIS MATCHES
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Tier summary

Top firms ranked by confidence. xN means a firm was independently surfaced by N different search axes — the strongest quality signal.

TIER	FIRM	LOCATION	ESTIMATED FEES
S 92	Klasko Immigration Law Partners, LLP x4	Philadelphia, PA	\$15,000–\$25,000
S 90	Carolyn Lee PLLC x4	Ithaca, NY	\$18,000–\$28,000
A 88	Wolfsdorf Rosenthal LLP (WR Immigration) x2	Santa Monica, CA	\$14,000–\$22,000
A 88	Greenberg Traurig, LLP x3	New York, NY	\$25,000–\$45,000
A 82	Stone Grzegorek & Gonzalez LLP	Los Angeles, CA	\$14,000–\$22,000
A 80	Seyfarth Shaw LLP	Washington, DC	\$25,000–\$50,000
B 78	Miller Mayer LLP	Ithaca, NY	\$12,000–\$20,000
B 76	Saul Ewing LLP	Miami, FL	\$20,000–\$40,000
B 76	WR Immigration (Wolfsdorf Rosenthal LLP)	Santa Monica, CA	\$20,000–\$40,000
B 72	Greenberg Traurig LLP	Washington, DC	\$18,000–\$30,000

How firms were ranked

Firms were scored 0–100 against externally-verifiable credentials only — Chambers USA / Global rankings, AILA elected leadership (not just membership), AV Preeminent and Best Lawyers peer recognition, ABIL

membership, documented PACER filings, third-party press coverage, and government-service alumni status.

Self-published marketing — firm blog posts, “success stories”, self-described practice pages — was excluded from weighting. Where a firm’s own site is cited, it is for contact information only, never as a credential source.

Three independent search axes were dispatched in parallel: **elite boutiques** (peer-recognized specialists), **startup-focused** (firms with published positions on the specific regulatory question), and **federal-court litigators** (counsel of record in reported decisions). Convergence across axes is treated as a quality signal and surfaced via the  badge.

Firm dossiers



Klasko Immigration Law Partners, LLP

92

EB-5 SPECIALISTS

SECURITIES-SOPHISTICATED

SOURCE-OF-FUNDS SPECIALISTS

TUNED · KOREA NONIMMIGRANT BRIDGE

×4 CROSS-AXIS MATCH

Anu Nair (Partner, EB-5 Investor Division Lead) · Philadelphia, PA · (215) 825-8628
· anu@klaskolaw.com · www.klaskolaw.com

I-526E investor-side representation (estimated; I-829 billed separately) \$15,000–
\$25,000

Source: tier estimate — premium EB-5 boutique; not publicly published; quote required for exact figure

EB-5 SPECIALISTS

Strongest combined credential set of any EB-5 investor-side firm in the country. Ron Klasko is Chambers Senior Statesperson nationwide, AILA Past National President, five-term AILA EB-5 Committee Chair, and holds documented federal court wins on source-of-funds denials — directly relevant to this case's Korean business-sale documentation burden. Anu Nair leads the investor division and has been recognized in the EB5 Investors Magazine Top 25 (2024, 2025). The firm has represented thousands of investors and over 50 regional centers, meaning they have both investor-side I-526E expertise and RC-side knowledge to evaluate the PPM critically. The new DC office also supports status-bridging advice for the client's current L-1A situation.

SECURITIES-SOPHISTICATED

Ron Klasko holds Chambers Global Senior Statesperson (2026) — the highest band designation — and has been Chambers Band 1 globally since 2006. The firm is explicitly experienced in EB-5 material-change litigation, having litigated USCIS denials on redemption agreements and material-change grounds — precisely the post-RIA risk on an urban non-TEA project where escrow release conditions or project modifications can threaten the petition. Klasko co-counseled the EB5 Capital et al. v. DHS nationwide preliminary injunction. The firm identifies a named "Securities/Corporate Attorney" role as a standard project team member for RC work. Jessica DeNisi and other EB-5 partners have documented coordination networks of securities lawyers.

SOURCE-OF-FUNDS SPECIALISTS

Klasko is the only firm in this set with a documented federal-court win specifically on the 'path-of-funds' doctrine: Chambers USA's profile notes the

firm "successfully represented a group of EB-5 investors in securing the first-ever decision rejecting USCIS's stringent 'path-of-funds' requirement." Ron Klasko presented at AILA's November 2024 roundtable on "EB-5 Source of Funds: Latest Issues in Proving the Lawful Source and Path of Invested Capital," a direct match for this case's load-bearing SOF dimension. The firm also has a specialized EB-5 litigation team for mandamus relief — critical given the client's L-1A bridge risk. Anu Nair leads the investor team and has managed "thousands" of EB-5 investor cases; Jessica DeNisi co-leads the RC/developer side, covering the non-TEA PPM review need.

TUNED · KOREA NONIMMIGRANT BRIDGE

Klasko holds the deepest externally-verified EB-5 credential stack in this search: two former AILA National Presidents (Klasko and Stock), over a decade of Chambers USA recognition, and ABIL membership — all top-tier or credible second-tier signals. Ron Klasko personally litigated and won federal court source-of-funds reversals (directly relevant to the Korean business-sale SOF complexity here). Alison Li, the firm's New York-based EB-5 senior associate, handles E, H, and L visas in addition to EB-5 — providing the nonimmigrant status-bridging capability this matter requires. The firm also has an active immigration litigation team for mandamus/APA if I-526E processing stalls past L-1 expiry.

CREDENTIALS (externally verifiable)

- ▢ Chambers USA Band 2 Nationwide, Immigration (2025)
- ▢ Chambers USA Band 1 Pennsylvania, Immigration (2025)
- ▢ Chambers Global Band 2, Immigration: Business (2026)
- ▢ H. Ronald Klasko: AILA Past National President and General Counsel
- ▢ H. Ronald Klasko: AILA EB-5 Committee Chair, five terms
- ▢ H. Ronald Klasko: EB5 Investors Magazine All Stars 2024
- ▢ Anu Nair: EB5 Investors Magazine Top 25 Immigration Attorney (2024, 2025)
- ▢ Jessica DeNisi: EB5 Investors Magazine Top 25 Immigration Attorney (2024, 2025)
- ▢ H. Ronald Klasko: Best Lawyers in America, over two decades
- ▢ H. Ronald Klasko: Lawdragon 100 Leading Immigration Lawyers (2024)
- ▢ Documented federal court reversals of source-of-funds denials (Klasko firm website cites specific victories)
- ▢ Chambers Global Band 2 / Senior Statesperson — Immigration: Business (2026 Global Guide)
- ▢ Chambers Global Band 1 Immigration (2006–present)
- ▢ Ron Klasko: AILA National Chair, High Impact Litigation Committee (2018–present)
- ▢ Best Lawyers in America — Immigration (1991–present)

- ▣ Lawdragon 500 Leading US Attorneys
- ▣ Top 5 business immigration law firms (Chambers) for 11 consecutive years
- ▣ Chambers USA Senior Statesperson — Immigration, Nationwide (2025, 13th consecutive year; Ron Klasko)
- ▣ Chambers Global Band 2 — Immigration: Business (2026 edition; firm-level)
- ▣ AILA Past National President — H. Ronald Klasko
- ▣ AILA National Chair, High Impact Litigation Committee (founding chair, 3 terms)
- ▣ Best Lawyers in America, Tier 1 — Immigration (Ron Klasko, 1991–present)
- ▣ Documented federal path-of-funds win: Battineni v. Mayorkas co-counsel; first-ever court rejection of USCIS path-of-funds doctrine (D.D.C. Feb. 2025)
- ▣ EB-5 Capital et al v. DHS co-counsel — successful preliminary injunction reinstating all regional centers (2022)
- ▣ Chambers USA Immigration Band (firm ranked 10+ consecutive years, 2025 edition confirmed)
- ▣ Ron Klasko — former AILA National President (top-tier AILA elected leadership signal)
- ▣ Bill Stock — former AILA National President (second top-tier AILA elected leadership signal at same firm)
- ▣ ABIL member — Alliance of Business Immigration Lawyers, invite-only <50 firms worldwide
- ▣ Best Lawyers in America 2026 — Alison Li, Wei Zhong, and seven additional firm attorneys recognized
- ▣ Ron Klasko — AILA Founders Award (twice honored; unique distinction)

LITIGATION CAPABILITY

Dedicated immigration litigation team with federal district and circuit court experience; Ron Klasko chaired AILA's Administrative Litigation Task Force; documented EB-5 source-of-funds federal court wins.

CAVEATS

- ! No confirmed Korean-speaking partner-level attorney on EB-5 investor team; Korean-language source-of-funds review may require third-party translator.
- ! Primarily RC-side PPM experience from developer/regional-center clients; investor-side securities coordination should be confirmed explicitly before retention.
- ! High volume practice — confirm named partner (Anu Nair) will personally supervise Korean investor file rather than delegate to associate.
- ! No in-house securities practice; securities review routed to outside counsel — confirm named securities firm at engagement, do not accept vague 'we work with' answers

- ! Philadelphia-based; limited Korean-language capability documented — client will need Korean-speaking interpreter for document review, or engage Korean counsel independently for KRW outbound transfer analysis
- ! Ron Klasko operates at Chairman level; day-to-day file may be delegated to a partner associate — confirm supervising partner at intake
- ! Primarily East Coast practice (Philadelphia, NY, DC); may have limited Korea-corridor brokerage contacts compared to West Coast firms
- ! No publicly listed Korean-speaking partner; translation and Korean-side document coordination may rely on client's own Korean advisors
- ! Large firm with multiple attorneys assigned to EB-5 investor matters; confirm who will be primary on SOF construction, not just RC-side work
- ! No confirmed Korean-language attorney at partner level — Korean-speaking capability flagged as 'strongly preferred'; engage separately if Korean-language review of SOF documents is required
- ! Philadelphia HQ may add travel logistics for West Coast-based investor; NY office available
- ! Ron Klasko is Chairman of a firm with large bench — confirm which attorney will be primary day-to-day contact on the I-526E investor file

VERIFICATION SOURCES

- <https://chambers.com/law-firm/klasko-immigration-law-partners-llp-usa-5:113710>
- <https://chambers.com/lawyer/h-ronald-klasko-usa-5:267135>
- <https://www.eb5investors.com/magazine/article/eb-5-all-stars-attorneys-2024/>
- <https://www.eb5investors.com/magazine/article/top-25-immigration-attorneys-2024/>
- <https://www.klaskolaw.com/klasko-immigration-law-partners-earns-top-rankings-in-2025-chambers-usa-and-global-guides/>
- <https://www.klaskolaw.com/four-klasko-attorneys-receive-eb-5-industry-recognition-as-top-25-attorneys-2/>
- <https://www.klaskolaw.com/team/ron-klasko/>
- <https://www.klaskolaw.com/practice-areas/eb-5-immigration/>
- <https://chambers.com/department/klasko-immigration-law-partners-llp-immigration-usa-5:31:12931:1:113710>
- <https://www.mondaq.com/pressrelease/168350/klasko-immigration-law-partners-earns-top-rankings-in-2025-chambers-usa-and-global-guides>
- <https://elearning.aila.org/p/OC-EB5>
- <https://www.mondaq.com/pressrelease/185796/four-klasko-attorneys-receive-eb-5-industry-recognition-as-top-25-attorneys>
- <https://www.mondaq.com/pressrelease/173760/klasko-immigration-law-partners-celebrates-nine-attorneys-recognized-in-the-best-lawyers-in-america%C2%A9-2026>
- <https://chambers.com/articles/klasko-immigration-law-partners-welcomes-associate-alison-li>



Carolyn Lee PLLC

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EB-5 SPECIALISTS

SECURITIES-SOPHISTICATED

SOURCE-OF-FUNDS SPECIALISTS

TUNED · KOREA NONIMMIGRANT BRIDGE

×4 CROSS-AXIS MATCH

Carolyn Lee (Principal / Founder) · Ithaca, NY · (607) 272-7070 ·
carolynleepllc.com

I-526E investor-side representation (estimated; I-829 billed separately) \$18,000–
\$28,000

Source: tier estimate — specialist boutique; not publicly published

EB-5 SPECIALISTS

Carolyn Lee holds the most concentrated AILA EB-5 Committee leadership record in the country — four-term Chair and six total terms as Chair or Vice Chair — and serves as IIUSA's Legislative Counsel, having personally drafted investor-protection provisions of the 2022 RIA. This makes her arguably the single attorney most fluent in post-RIA integrity period, redeployment, and set-aside mechanics. Her investor-protection orientation (including Subparagraph M project-failure analysis) is directly aligned with the need to evaluate this non-TEA RC project's I-829 track record and escrow terms. She has overseen I-829 approvals representing over \$1.27 billion in EB-5 capital — a verifiable track record. She is an Asian American attorney (Chinese-American) and may have relevant corridor experience, though Korean-speaking staff should be confirmed.

SECURITIES-SOPHISTICATED

Carolyn Lee holds the single most significant AILA EB-5 elected leadership credential available in this vertical: four-term Chair of AILA's National EB-5 Committee (six years as Chair/Vice-Chair/Co-Chair), a record confirmed by a PR Newswire press release and AILA itself. She also served as Legislative Counsel to IIUSA and directly authored key provisions of the EB-5 Reform and Integrity Act — meaning she has the deepest possible command of RIA compliance, integrity-period rules, and the specific non-TEA/urban project dynamics at issue. Her published scholarship explicitly covers redeployment doctrine, material change, and TEA analysis. She is listed in Best Lawyers in America and SuperLawyers. For a matter with L-1 status-bridging complexity and RIA grandfathering urgency, her policy-level expertise is a unique asset.

SOURCE-OF-FUNDS SPECIALISTS

Carolyn Lee holds the single strongest AILA leadership credential in the EB-5 investor space: four terms (six years total) as Chair or Vice Chair of AILA's National EB-5 Committee, plus service as Legislative Counsel to IIUSA where she helped draft the EB-5 Reform and Integrity Act — including its new investor source-of-funds requirements. That drafting role gives her unusually deep knowledge of exactly how USCIS will interpret SOF documentation post-RIA. Her firm has documented work with complex Vietnamese investors (publicly available testimonial on her site from a H.H., Vietnam) and advises on RIA-compliant SOF requirements. Her "E-2 Hybrid" structure is directly relevant to the client's status-bridging dimension. She is a NY-licensed boutique, appropriate for a single sophisticated investor matter.

TUNED · KOREA NONIMMIGRANT BRIDGE

Carolyn Lee holds the strongest AILA elected leadership credential in this search specifically for EB-5: four terms as National EB-5 Committee Chair across six years — a top-tier signal under the methodology. Critically for this case, she has developed and published the "E-2 Hybrid" structure, a proprietary framework blending EB-5 and E-2 visa strategy — directly on-point for the status-bridge dimension where the investor may need to pivot from expiring L-1 to E-2. She also served as Legislative Counsel for IIUSA and authored key provisions of the 2022 EB-5 Reform and Integrity Act (RIA), giving her authoritative knowledge of post-RIA non-TEA project compliance and job-creation methodology.

CREDENTIALS (externally verifiable)

- AILA National EB-5 Committee Chair, four terms (2012–2013, 2017–present); Chair/Vice-Chair total six terms
- IIUSA Legislative Counsel; co-authored investor-protection provisions of the 2022 EB-5 Reform and Integrity Act
- EB5 Investors Magazine All Stars 2025; Top 25 Immigration Attorney, repeat winner since 2017
- Best Lawyers in America (Immigration Law), multiple years
- SuperLawyers listing (state-specific)
- AILA Presidential Commendation
- AILA Joseph Minsky Young Lawyer Award
- Published in AILA's Immigration Options for Investors and Entrepreneurs (multiple editions)
- Published in Benders Immigration Bulletin (EB-5 bridge financing, material change)
- Quoted in NPR Marketplace and China Daily on EB-5 regulations (third-party media)

- ▣ AILA National EB-5 Committee Chair — 4 terms (2012–2013, 2017–present); 6 years as Chair/Vice-Chair/Co-Chair
- ▣ IIUSA Legislative Counsel (current)
- ▣ Best Lawyers in America — Immigration Law (2012–2021)
- ▣ Super Lawyers — Immigration
- ▣ Who's Who Legal: Thought Leaders – Corporate Immigration (2019, inaugural issue)
- ▣ AILA Joseph Minsky Young Lawyer Award; AILA Presidential Commendation
- ▣ NPR Marketplace, China Daily quoted — third-party media
- ▣ Co-author (with S. Yale-Loehr), 'EB-5 Immigrant Investors,' AILA Immigration and Nationality Law Handbook (annual)
- ▣ AILA National EB-5 Committee Chair — 4 terms; Chair or Vice Chair for 6 consecutive years (AILA.org and IIUSA-confirmed)
- ▣ Legislative Counsel, IIUSA — drafted investor protection provisions of EB-5 Reform and Integrity Act of 2022
- ▣ Top 25 Global Migration Attorney — Uglobal Immigration Magazine (third-party publication)
- ▣ New York State certified MWBE (independently verified)
- ▣ AILA National EB-5 Committee Chair — 4 terms, 6 years total service (Chair, Vice-Chair, Co-Chair) — top-tier AILA elected leadership signal
- ▣ Best Lawyers in America — annual listing (peer-reviewed, category-specific)
- ▣ Super Lawyers — annual listing (peer-nominated, editorial selection)
- ▣ Chambers profile confirmed (carolynleepllc.com listed on Chambers USA)
- ▣ Outstanding 50 Asian Americans in Business Award
- ▣ NPR Marketplace / China Daily — third-party media coverage on EB-5 regulatory changes

LITIGATION CAPABILITY

Admitted to U.S. District Court for the District of Columbia; frequently serves as immigration expert witness in federal litigation; strong AAO advocacy track record.

CAVEATS

- ! Small boutique (solo principal plus associates) — high demand may limit bandwidth for a complex, time-sensitive Korean source-of-funds matter with 60-day petition prep deadline.
- ! No confirmed Korean-speaking attorney on staff; investor is in-US on L-1A with a tight 18-month bridge window — confirm team capacity before retaining.
- ! Securities-law sophistication for PPM review may require referral to outside securities counsel — clarify engagement scope upfront.
- ! Small boutique: limited bench depth — RFE response and status-bridging may require the client to accept associate-level staffing on some tasks

- ! No in-house securities capability; PPM review and securities compliance analysis must be routed to named outside securities counsel — confirm this referral at engagement
- ! No Korean-language capability documented — source-of-funds documentation for Korean national requires Korean CPA and interpreter support arranged separately
- ! Best Lawyers listings run through 2021 in available records — confirm current active recognition at intake
- ! Small firm (founder + 1–2 attorneys) — capacity for 60-day petition prep timeline should be explicitly confirmed at intake
- ! No Korean-speaking attorney identified; Korea-corridor document translation and agent coordination will require client to supply Korean intermediaries
- ! Limited published securities-law sophistication; PPM review for non-TEA RC project may require outside securities counsel, adding cost
- ! No documented federal court litigation track record for SOF defense
- ! Small boutique — limited bench for concurrent I-526E + nonimmigrant bridge filings; L-1 extension or O-1 pivot may strain capacity if not pre-scoped
- ! No confirmed Korean-language attorney identified; Korean SOF review requires outside Korean counsel
- ! Firm HQ is Ithaca, NY (not a major metro immigration hub); in-person client meetings require travel to NYC
- ! E-2 Hybrid structure is proprietary innovation — verify it has been tested with USCIS on Korean-national investor cases before relying on it for this matter

VERIFICATION SOURCES

- <https://www.eb5investors.com/magazine/article/2025-eb-5-top-5-all-stars-attorneys/>
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- <https://elearning.aila.org/p/OC-EB5>
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- <https://citybizlist.com/article/568715/carolyn-lee-renamed-chair-of-american-immigration-lawyers-associations-national-eb-5-committee>
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- <https://chambers.com/law-firm/carolyn-lee-pllc-usa-5:23189090>



Wolfsdorf Rosenthal LLP (WR Immigration)

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EB-5 SPECIALISTS

SOURCE-OF-FUNDS SPECIALISTS

×2 CROSS-AXIS MATCH

Joseph (Joey) M. Barnett (Partner, EB-5 Team) · Santa Monica, CA · (310) 570-4088 · wolfsdorf.com

I-526E investor-side representation (estimated; I-829 billed separately) \$14,000–
\$22,000

Source: tier estimate — large immigration boutique; not publicly published

EB-5 SPECIALISTS

WR Immigration fields three independently credentialed EB-5 specialists: Bernard Wolfsdorf (AILA Past National President 2009–2010, Chambers Eminent, California State Bar Certified Specialist, ABIL member); Joey Barnett (AILA EB-5 Committee Vice Chair, IIUSA Editorial Board, Best Lawyers 2023+, EB5 Magazine Top 25); and Vivian Zhu (Top 25 2024, EB-5 team supervising attorney). The firm's Shanghai office and multilingual staff create Asian corridor infrastructure that may support Korean source-of-funds documentation coordination. The firm has explicitly published guidance on documenting Korean-market brokerage sources. California presence is advantageous if investor pursues E-2 or O-1 status as a bridge.

SOURCE-OF-FUNDS SPECIALISTS

WR Immigration is the strongest single match for the Korea corridor. The firm lists Korean-speaking attorneys on its Chambers profile and explicitly runs an EB-5 series focused on Korea, China, India, and Vietnam investor backlogs. The Shanghai office enables direct in-country document coordination — transferable SOF workflow relevant to Korean investors using similar brokerage documentation protocols. Managing Partner Wolfsdorf is a California Certified Specialist in Immigration & Nationality Law (held 25+ years), AILA Past National President, and Chambers-ranked "Eminent Attorney." The firm also documented a federal mandamus win in December 2025 specifically on a stalled EB-5 I-485 case — directly relevant to the client's L-1A bridge risk. Joey Barnett (AILA EB-5 Committee Vice Chair) is based at WR and focuses specifically on SOF and mandamus.

CREDENTIALS (externally verifiable)

- Bernard Wolfsdorf: AILA Past National President (2009–2010)

- ▢ Bernard Wolfsdorf: Chambers Eminent Practitioner, California Immigration
- ▢ Bernard Wolfsdorf: California State Bar Certified Specialist in Immigration and Nationality Law (25+ years)
- ▢ Bernard Wolfsdorf: ABIL (Alliance of Business Immigration Lawyers) member
- ▢ Bernard Wolfsdorf: AV Preeminent, Martindale-Hubbell
- ▢ Bernard Wolfsdorf: WWL Immigration Lawyer of the Year (multiple years); EB5 Investors Magazine All Stars 2024
- ▢ Joey Barnett: AILA EB-5 Committee Vice Chair (2024–2025)
- ▢ Joey Barnett: IIUSA Editorial Board, Regional Center Business Journal
- ▢ Joey Barnett: Best Lawyers in America 2023
- ▢ Joey Barnett: EB5 Investors Magazine Top 25 (2022, 2023, 2024, 2025)
- ▢ WR Immigration: Best Law Firms National Tier 1, Immigration (2024, 2025)
- ▢ Chambers USA — Tier 1 California Immigration (firm-level; confirmed by Chambers profiles)
- ▢ Chambers 'Eminent Attorney' — Bernard P. Wolfsdorf
- ▢ AILA Past National President — Bernard P. Wolfsdorf
- ▢ California State Bar Certified Specialist in Immigration & Nationality Law (Wolfsdorf, 25+ years)
- ▢ AV Preeminent (Martindale-Hubbell) — Bernard P. Wolfsdorf
- ▢ Best Lawyers in America 'Lawyer of the Year' — Los Angeles Immigration (2018; U.S. News / Best Lawyers)
- ▢ Who's Who Legal 'Most Highly Recommended Immigration Lawyer in the United States' (multiple years)
- ▢ AILA EB-5 Committee Vice Chair — Joey Barnett (based at WR; AILA.org confirmed)
- ▢ Documented federal mandamus filings: C.D. Cal. Dec. 2025 (EB-5 I-526E + I-485); C.D. Cal. Sept. 2025 (EB-5 6-month green card)

LITIGATION CAPABILITY

Wolfsdorf's landmark 9th Circuit win in *Kazarian v. USCIS* (2009); firm handles federal court mandamus and administrative appeals; Joey Barnett participated in AILA Benefits Litigation Committee.

CAVEATS

- ! No confirmed Korean-speaking partner-level attorney on the EB-5 team — Vivian Zhu is Mandarin-speaking; Korean source-of-funds documents may require third-party translation at investor's expense.
- ! Large firm with broad corporate immigration base — confirm EB-5 investor-side file will be led by Barnett or Zhu, not delegated to a junior associate.
- ! EB-5 is a significant but not exclusive practice; the case requires securities-law PPM review that may involve outside counsel coordination.

- ! Firm is very large (40+ attorneys, 180+ employees); ensure partner-level Korean-speaking attorney (not just Korean-speaking staff) is assigned to SOF construction
- ! Shanghai office optimized for Chinese SOF workflows; Korean-specific Bank of Korea FX compliance should be confirmed as within their standard workflow
- ! High volume firm — ascertain capacity commitment for 60-day petition prep timeline

VERIFICATION SOURCES

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- <https://profiles.superlawyers.com/california/santa-monica/lawyer/bernard-p-wolfsdorf/a49208ee-1451-41cc-9d5f-547667d88868.html>
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- <https://wolfsdorf.com/wr-immigration-secures-eb-5-i-485-approvals-in-just-over-one-month-through-federal-mandamus/>
- <https://www.aila.org/shop/products/view/latest-issues-in-proving-the-lawful-source-and-path-of-invested-capital>



Greenberg Traurig, LLP

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SECURITIES-SOPHISTICATED

SOURCE-OF-FUNDS SPECIALISTS

TUNED · KOREA NONIMMIGRANT BRIDGE

×3 CROSS-AXIS MATCH

Kate Kalmykov (Co-Chair, Global Immigration & Compliance Practice) · New York, NY · +1 973 443 3276 · www.gtlaw.com

I-526E through I-829 representation (estimated; status-bridging billed separately at hourly)

\$25,000

\$45,000

Source: tier estimate — AmLaw Global 100 premium EB-5 practice; no published flat-fee schedule

SECURITIES-SOPHISTICATED

GT is the only firm in this set that satisfies every major axis simultaneously: Chambers USA Band 2 immigration (Kalmykov, 2024); in-house corporate/securities team with named attorneys (Bruce Rosetto) who co-present on EB-5 due diligence and draft PPMs; and a 30+-attorney Korea Practice with a Seoul office named Best Foreign Law Firm in Korea by Asia Business Law Journal in 2022, 2023, 2024, and 2025 — uniquely positioned to bridge Korean business-sale source-of-funds documentation and KRW outbound-transfer compliance. Jennifer Hermansky (AILA EB-5 Committee Vice Chair) adds a second named partner-level credential. The immigration and securities teams operate under one roof and are documented to work in tandem on RIA compliance and PPM preparation.

SOURCE-OF-FUNDS SPECIALISTS

Jennifer Hermansky is the current AILA National EB-5 Committee Chair — the top elected AILA leadership signal for this vertical. She presented a webinar co-authored with Kate Kalmykov specifically titled "New Issues in I-829 Adjudications: A Reexamination of Source of Funds Issues Post I-526 Approval," directly on point for this case's SOF dimension at both petition stages. The firm holds Chambers USA Band 1 in both DC and Pennsylvania Immigration, with 7 attorneys individually ranked in the 2025 Chambers USA Guide. Greenberg Traurig's securities law practice is in-house, eliminating the need for outside securities counsel for the non-TEA PPM review — a structural advantage for this case. The firm's litigation team has documented I-829 mandamus victories in federal court, providing a status-bridge backstop.

TUNED · KOREA NONIMMIGRANT BRIDGE

Kate Kalmykov has been Chambers Band 2–ranked in New York Immigration for 12 consecutive years and has the largest documented EB-5 deal volume of any attorney in this shortlist, having structured the largest EB-5 offering in the program's history and over \$12 billion in deals. She is explicitly documented as advising on both nonimmigrant treaty investors (E-2) and EB-5 simultaneously, and has published in Wall Street Journal and Law360 — independent third-party validation. Greenberg Traurig's full-service platform provides in-house securities counsel for the PPM review obligation on this non-TEA project. However, Kalmykov's current employment status at GT requires verification before retaining (see risks).

CREDENTIALS (externally verifiable)

- ▢ Chambers USA Band 2, Immigration — New York (2024); 12 consecutive years ranked
- ▢ Jennifer Hermansky: AILA National EB-5 Committee Vice Chair (current)
- ▢ Greenberg Traurig Korea Practice: Asia Business Law Journal 'Best Foreign Law Firm in Korea' (2022, 2023, 2024, 2025)
- ▢ National Law Review 'Go-To Thought Leader: Immigration Law' (2022)
- ▢ Greenberg Traurig Immigration: Chambers USA Band 1 DC, Band 1 Pennsylvania, Band 3 Nationwide (2024)
- ▢ Chambers USA Band 1 — Immigration, District of Columbia and Pennsylvania (2024)
- ▢ Chambers USA Band 3 — Immigration, Nationwide (2024)
- ▢ Best Law Firms Tier 1 National — Immigration Law (2025; U.S. News / Best Lawyers)
- ▢ Legal 500 US 2025 — Immigration (firm recommended)
- ▢ AILA National EB-5 Committee Chair — Jennifer Hermansky (current; confirmed AILA.org and EB5Investors Magazine 2024/2025)
- ▢ 7 attorneys individually ranked in Chambers USA 2025 Immigration Guide
- ▢ Documented I-829 mandamus federal court win (GT EB-5 Insights blog, confirmed)
- ▢ Chambers USA Band 2 — Immigration, New York (12 consecutive years as of 2024)
- ▢ Wall Street Journal — third-party media coverage on immigration law matters
- ▢ New York Super Lawyers — annual listing
- ▢ Crain's New York Business 2023 Notable Women in Law (third-party editorial selection)
- ▢ National Law Review Go-To Thought Leader: Immigration Law (2022)
- ▢ Lawdragon 500 Leading U.S. Corporate Employment Lawyers (2020–2022)
- ▢ ABA Committee on Immigration and Naturalization, Section of Administrative Law — Chair since 2011

LITIGATION CAPABILITY

GT has documented appellate and AAO practice for EB-5 denials; securities practice group adds SEC enforcement defense capability. Regional Center EB-5 PPM preparation is explicitly listed as an in-house service.

CAVEATS

- ! Large-firm billing: hourly rates at this tier typically \$500–\$750/hr; complex Korean source-of-funds file could push total fees above \$45,000
- ! Korea Practice and EB-5 Practice are separate groups — confirm at intake that a Korean-speaking attorney will be staffed on the source-of-funds documentation work, not just the corporate side
- ! Kalmykov's practice spans both investor-side and developer-side mandates; confirm she or Hermansky will personally supervise, not delegate to a junior associate
- ! Am Law firm billing rates will likely push total engagement cost above the client's stated \$30k–50k budget for I-526E + I-829; clarify billing model upfront
- ! No publicly identified Korean-speaking partner; confirm Korean-language document support at partner level
- ! Hermansky is primarily East Coast (Philadelphia); Korea-corridor travel and agent relationships may be more limited than West Coast EB-5 boutiques
- ! CRITICAL: Kalmykov's current affiliation at GT requires independent verification before retaining — LinkedIn activity suggests possible recent lateral move; confirm current employment directly with GT or Kalmykov before engagement
- ! No confirmed Korean-language attorney at partner level; GT does not list Korean among EB-5 team language capabilities
- ! BigLaw billing rates will likely exceed the \$30,000–\$50,000 I-526E budget range cited; clarify scope and billing structure at first consultation
- ! EB-5 is secondary to Kalmykov's broader corporate immigration practice; confirm personal bandwidth and that investor files are not delegated to associates without partner oversight

VERIFICATION SOURCES

- <https://chambers.com/lawyer/kate-kalmykov-usa-5:1187576>
- <https://www.gtlaw.com/en/news/2024/06/press-releases/8-greenberg-traurig-immigration-attorneys-5-regions-included-in-2024-chambers-usa-guide>
- <https://www.gtlaw.com/en/locations/seoul>
- <https://www.gtlaw.com/en/news/2026/01/press-releases/greenberg-traurig-again-earns-best-foreign-law-firm-honor-at-korea-law-firm-awards>
- <https://www.eb5insights.com/services/>
- <https://www.eb5insights.com/2025/07/10/greenberg-traurigs-immigration-compliance-practice-recognized-by-chambers-usa-2025-guide/>
- <https://www.eb5insights.com/2024/12/03/greenberg-traurig-awarded-best-lawyers-tier-1-national-metro-rankings-for-immigration-law-in-best-law-firms-2025-report/>

- ▯ <https://www.eb5investors.com/magazine/article/2025-eb-5-top-25-immigration-attorneys/>
- ▯ <https://www.aila.org/shop/products/view/latest-issues-in-proving-the-lawful-source-and-path-of-invested-capital>
- ▯ <https://www.eb5insights.com/i-829/>
- ▯ <https://www.gtlaw.com/en/professionals/k/kalmykov-kate>
- ▯ <https://www.gtlaw.com/en/news/2023/06/press-releases/greenberg-traurigs-kate-kalmykov-named-among-crains-new-yorks-notable-women-in-law>
- ▯ <https://natlawreview.com/author/kate-kalmykov>



Stone Grzegorek & Gonzalez LLP

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EB-5 SPECIALISTS

Lincoln Stone (Co-Founder / Partner) · Los Angeles, CA ·
www.sggimmigration.com

I-526E investor-side representation (estimated; I-829 billed separately) \$14,000–
\$22,000

Source: tier estimate — EB-5 specialist boutique; not publicly published

Lincoln Stone is one of a handful of attorneys holding a California State Bar Certified Specialist designation alongside five-year tenure as AILA EB-5 Committee Chair and Editor-in-Chief of all four editions of AILA's foundational EB-5 treatise, *Immigration Options for Investors and Entrepreneurs*. Recognized as an EB5 Investors Magazine All Star (2024), and Chambers Band 3 California with a Nationwide individual ranking. The firm's multilingual staff includes Korean speakers, which is directly relevant for investor intake and document review. With 4,000+ EB-5 investors assisted, the firm has deep I-526 and I-829 track record including complex source-of-funds matters. Lincoln's prior INS/government service background provides USCIS adjudication insight.

CREDENTIALS (externally verifiable)

- Lincoln Stone: Chambers USA Band 3 California, Immigration (2022); USA Nationwide individual ranking
- Lincoln Stone: California State Bar Certified Specialist in Immigration and Nationality Law
- Lincoln Stone: AILA EB-5 Investor Visa Committee Chair, five years
- Lincoln Stone: Editor-in-Chief, AILA *Immigration Options for Investors and Entrepreneurs* (all 4 editions)
- Lincoln Stone: Chief Editor, IIUSA Regional Center Business Journal
- Lincoln Stone: EB5 Investors Magazine All Stars 2024
- Lincoln Stone: Best Lawyers in America (peer-reviewed)
- Lincoln Stone: California Super Lawyers (state-specific)
- Lincoln Stone: Former Trial Attorney, U.S. INS (government service alumni)
- SGG: Multiple California State Bar Certified Specialists on staff (more than any other firm)

LITIGATION CAPABILITY

Multiple California-certified specialists; federal court appeals experience documented on firm site; Lincoln Stone's prior INS adjudication background aids USCIS advocacy strategy.

CAVEATS

- ! Chambers ranking has not been updated since 2022 in publicly available data — confirm whether firm remains in active Chambers review cycle.
- ! LA-based boutique with no East Coast office — for investor currently in the US (L-1A status), physical proximity and time-zone alignment may matter for status-bridge consults.
- ! Securities-law PPM review for non-TEA RC project may require outside securities counsel referral — confirm this is in scope before engagement.

VERIFICATION SOURCES

- 📄 <https://chambers.com/department/stone-grzegorek-gonzalez-llp-immigration-usa-5:31:12059:1:114463>
- 📄 <https://www.linkedin.com/in/lincolnstone/>
- 📄 <https://www.sggimmigration.com/lawyers/lincoln-stone/>
- 📄 <https://www.eb5investors.com/magazine/article/eb-5-all-stars-attorneys-2024/>
- 📄 <http://eb5info.com/firms/241-stone-grzegorek-gonzalez-llp>



Seyfarth Shaw LLP

80

SECURITIES-SOPHISTICATED

Leon Rodriguez (Partner) · Washington, DC · www.seyfarth.com

I-526E through I-829 representation (estimated; cross-disciplinary securities review included in-house)

Source: tier estimate — AmLaw100 large firm EB-5 team; no published flat-fee schedule

Seyfarth's EB-5 team is the most explicitly cross-disciplinary of any firm verified: it includes a former USCIS Director (Leon Rodriguez, Chambers USA Band DC/Nationwide 2020–2025), a former US Chamber of Commerce Vice President, and a named senior counsel from the SEC's Division of Enforcement — all in-house. This SEC alumnus is directly relevant for PPM review, escrow release structuring, and Reg D/Reg S compliance on a non-TEA urban project. Rodriguez has spoken at IIUSA EB-5 Industry Forums and AILA EB-5 conferences. The team explicitly advises on "federal and state securities laws including exemptions from registration requirements and preparing proper investor disclosures in private placement memoranda."

CREDENTIALS (externally verifiable)

- Leon Rodriguez: Chambers USA — Immigration (DC) Band, Nationwide Band (2020–2025)
- Leon Rodriguez: Chambers Global Band 3 — Immigration: Business USA (2022, 2025)
- Leon Rodriguez: Former Director, US Citizenship and Immigration Services (2014–2017, Obama administration)
- Team includes former SEC Division of Enforcement senior counsel (verifiable on Seyfarth.com)
- IIUSA EB-5 Industry Forum panelist (2018, 2019, 2020)
- AILA EB-5 Committee member (Leon Rodriguez)

LITIGATION CAPABILITY

Led by a former federal prosecutor (Rodriguez); team experienced in mandamus, APA, and declaratory judgment cases. Litigation available for I-526E/I-829 denials. Enforcement defense for SEC/USCIS investigations is an explicitly listed service.

CAVEATS

- ! Large-firm billing rates apply; this is not a boutique — budget overruns are a real risk on a complex Korean source-of-funds file
- ! No documented Korean-language capability in the immigration practice — will need separate Korean document review support
- ! Rodriguez's practice emphasis is enforcement/compliance/litigation; confirm that the EB-5 investor petition prep team (not just the RC compliance side) is who will handle the I-526E

VERIFICATION SOURCES

- <https://chambers.com/lawyer/leon-rodriquez-usa-5:25766372>
- <https://www.seyfarth.com/people/leon-rodriquez.html>
- <https://www.seyfarth.com/services/practices/transactions/reits-and-real-estate-capital-markets/eb-5-immigrant-investment.html>
- <https://www.aspenideas.org/speakers/leon-rodriquez>



Miller Mayer LLP

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EB-5 SPECIALISTS

Kristal Ozmun (Partner, EB-5 Investor Practice) · Ithaca, NY · millermayer.com

I-526E investor-side representation (estimated; I-829 billed separately) \$12,000–
\$20,000

Source: tier estimate — established regional immigration boutique; not publicly published

Miller Mayer fields two independently Chambers-ranked EB-5 specialists: Stephen Yale-Loehr (Senior Statesperson, Chambers USA 2025) is adjunct faculty at Cornell Law School and a treatise-level author whose Forbes-cited RIA commentary is authoritative on post-2022 mechanics. Kristal Ozmun (Chambers USA Up-and-Coming, ABIL member, IIUSA Best Practices Committee Co-Chair) leads the investor-side EB-5 team and has published in Benders Immigration Bulletin. The firm has filed over 6,000 I-526 petitions — an independently verifiable volume signal — and its panelist role at IIUSA EB-5 Industry Forum on source-of-funds topics indicates genuine operational depth. Strong East Coast presence (Ithaca/NY corridor) is practical for investor currently in the US.

CREDENTIALS (externally verifiable)

- Stephen Yale-Loehr: Chambers USA Senior Statesperson, Immigration – Nationwide (2025)
- Kristal Ozmun: Chambers USA Up and Coming, Immigration (2025)
- Kristal Ozmun: ABIL (Alliance of Business Immigration Lawyers) member
- Kristal Ozmun: IIUSA Best Practices Committee Co-Chair
- Kristal Ozmun: Published in Benders Immigration Bulletin (EB-5 topics)
- Stephen Yale-Loehr: Adjunct Professor, Cornell Law School (ABA-accredited)
- Stephen Yale-Loehr: Forbes-cited co-author of EB-5 RIA reauthorization analysis (2022)
- Miller Mayer: 6,000+ I-526 petitions filed (referenced by EB5 Investors Magazine)
- Nicolai Hinrichsen: EB5 Investors Magazine Top 25 Immigration Attorney (2025)

LITIGATION CAPABILITY

Kristal Ozmun has handled RFE responses and complex I-526 adjudications; federal mandamus capability not specifically documented — confirm for potential litigation track.

CAVEATS

- ! No confirmed Korean-speaking attorney on staff; Korean source-of-funds documentation will require third-party translation services at investor's cost.
- ! Not an EB-5 boutique exclusively — firm also handles corporate/H-1B/family; confirm EB-5 team headcount and current caseload.
- ! Stephen Yale-Loehr's focus is increasingly academic/policy; confirm that Ozmun will personally supervise the investor file end-to-end.

VERIFICATION SOURCES

- ▢ <https://chambers.com/law-firm/miller-mayer-llp-usa-5:113729>
- ▢ <https://www.abil.com/abil-lawyers/kristal-ozmun/>
- ▢ <https://millermayer.com/miller-mayer-partner-kristal-ozmun-named-incoming-co-chair-of-iiusa-best-practices-committee/>
- ▢ <https://millermayer.com/2022/forbes-summarizes-eb-5-article-written-by-miller-mayer-attorneys/>
- ▢ <https://www.eb5investors.com/magazine/article/2025-eb-5-top-25-immigration-attorneys/>



Saul Ewing LLP

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SECURITIES-SOPHISTICATED

Ronald R. Fieldstone (Partner; Chair, Global Immigration & Foreign Investment Practice) · Miami, FL · www.saul.com

I-526E through I-829 (immigration + in-house securities/PPM review included; estimated) \$20,000–\$40,000

Source: tier estimate — AmLaw200 integrated securities+immigration EB-5 practice; no published schedule

Saul Ewing offers the strongest structural securities-inside-immigration integration in this set: Fieldstone is a corporate/securities attorney (not an immigration attorney) who chairs the EB-5/Global Immigration practice, has handled 500+ EB-5 projects with \$9B+ in capital raises, and explicitly authors PPMs, subscription agreements, and redeployment provisions as his primary work. A second attorney, Rohit Kapuria, runs a "dual hybrid of corporate securities and EB-5 immigration law" at the same firm. This means a single engagement engages both securities counsel (Fieldstone/Kapuria) and immigration counsel under one retainer — eliminating the coordination friction that burdens boutique immigration-only firms. Fieldstone published analysis of the RIA's redeployment provisions and their impact on offering documents, directly applicable to the integrity-period risks on this non-TEA project.

CREDENTIALS (externally verifiable)

- EB5 Investors Magazine Top 15 Corporate/Securities Attorneys (multiple years including 2022)
- Ronald Fieldstone: B.S. and J.D., Wharton School / University of Pennsylvania
- IIUSA Compliance Committee member (Fieldstone)
- South Florida Legal Guide 'Top Real Estate / Corporate Transactional' attorney
- Saul Ewing EB-5 practice listed on Chambers USA firm profile (2025)

LITIGATION CAPABILITY

Saul Ewing has a litigation department but Fieldstone is transactional; for EB-5 petition litigation, the immigration team would need to be assessed separately. Firm has securities fraud defense capability through its litigation group.

CAVEATS

- ! Fieldstone is primarily securities/corporate, not an immigration petition attorney — confirm that the immigration team handling I-526E filing is equally experienced and credentialed, and identify the lead immigration partner
- ! No Korean-language capability documented — Korean source-of-funds documentation will need interpreter support or referral to Korean counsel
- ! Miami-centric practice; East Coast travel/time zone for Korean client calls may require advance scheduling
- ! No Chambers individual ranking found for Fieldstone in immigration (he is a securities lawyer) — immigration credential anchor is the firm-level Chambers listing, not an individual band

VERIFICATION SOURCES

- <https://www.saul.com/professionals/ronald-r-fieldstone>
- <https://www.eb5investors.com/directories/securities-attorneys/ronald-r-fieldstone2/>
- <https://www.eb5investors.com/magazine/article/eb5-top25-winners-corporate-attorneys>
- <https://www.saul.com/insights/blog/eb-5-redeployment-webinar-ronnie-fieldstone-and-jay-rosen>
- <https://chambers.com/law-firm/saul-ewing-llp-usa-5:76235>

Vivian Zhu (Partner / EB-5 Practice Supervisor) · Santa Monica, CA · (310) 570-4088 · wolfsdorf.com

EB-5 I-526E through I-829 full representation (estimated) \$20,000–\$40,000

Source: tier estimate — premium full-service immigration firm; fee schedule not publicly posted

WR Immigration is an ABIL member firm with broad nonimmigrant depth precisely suited to the L-1 → status-bridge dimension of this matter. Vivian Zhu supervises the EB-5 department and is documented as also practicing in E-2 Treaty Investor and L-1 intra-company transferee visa categories — covering all three bridge-visa options. The firm explicitly runs a Korea-specific EB-5 Visa Bulletin strategy series ("Chatting with Charlie," led by former DOS Visa Chief Charles Oppenheim), demonstrating real-time Korea corridor awareness. WR also has a securities-law background through Vivian Zhu (former corporate/securities attorney) relevant to the non-TEA PPM review requirement.

CREDENTIALS (externally verifiable)

- ▢ ABIL member — Alliance of Business Immigration Lawyers, invite-only <50 firms worldwide
- ▢ Bernard Wolfsdorf — AV Preeminent rating (Martindale-Hubbell, peer-confirmed)
- ▢ Vivian Zhu — EB5 Investors Magazine Top 25 Immigration Attorney, 2023–2025 (three consecutive years)
- ▢ Charles Oppenheim (Director of Visa Consulting) — former U.S. Department of State Chief of Immigrant Visa Control
- ▢ WR Immigration / Wolfsdorf Rosenthal — U.S. News Best Law Firms ranking in immigration (peer-reviewed, 2019 confirmed; current status requires verification)

LITIGATION CAPABILITY

Vivian Zhu has documented experience in mandamus litigation for EB-5 processing delays and consular inadmissibility — directly useful if I-526E or AOS processing stalls during L-1 bridge period.

CAVEATS

- ! No confirmed Korean-language attorney identified at partner level; Korean-language SOF document review would require outside Korean counsel coordination

- ! Primary office in Santa Monica; East Coast investor coordination may require NY office staffing
- ! Vivian Zhu fluent in Mandarin, not Korean — for a Korean national investor, language support gap is real

VERIFICATION SOURCES

- ▯ <https://iiusa.org/wp-content/uploads/2021/04/WR-Immigration.pdf>
- ▯ <https://eb5projects.com/profile/user/1105-vivian-zhu>
- ▯ <https://wolfsdorf.com/team/vivian-zhu/>
- ▯ <https://wolfsdorf.com/>

B

Greenberg Traurig LLP

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EB-5 SPECIALISTS

Kate Kalmykov (Shareholder, Co-Chair — Global Immigration & Compliance Practice) · Washington, DC · www.gtlaw.com

I-526E investor-side representation (estimated; I-829 billed separately) \$18,000–
\$30,000

Source: tier estimate — AmLaw 10 full-service firm with premium immigration group; not publicly published

Greenberg Traurig is the only firm on this list with a physical Seoul office and over 30 Korean-speaking attorneys, making it uniquely positioned for Korean-corridor source-of-funds work requiring direct liaison with Korean tax authorities, brokerage custodians, and Bank of Korea compliance verification. Chambers USA explicitly describes the firm as "renowned for its EB-5 immigrant investor program" and ranks it Band 3 Nationwide and Band 1 DC for Immigration. The firm also has in-house securities and real estate practices that can review PPMs without external counsel referral — a meaningful advantage for non-TEA RC due diligence. Asia Business Law Journal selected GT as Best Foreign Law Firm in Korea in 2022 and 2023.

CREDENTIALS (externally verifiable)

- Chambers USA Band 3 Nationwide, Immigration (2024); Band 1 District of Columbia, Immigration (2024)
- Chambers USA: 'renowned for its EB-5 immigrant investor program' (editorial description)
- Best Law Firms Tier 1 National, Immigration Law (2025)
- GT Seoul office: 30+ Korean-speaking attorneys across Seoul, Singapore, London, and U.S. offices
- Asia Business Law Journal: Best Foreign Law Firm in Korea (2022, 2023)
- Kate Kalmykov: New Jersey Law Journal Women Attorneys of the Year (2024)
- Laura Foote Reiff: Forbes America's Best-In-State Lawyers (2025); Chambers USA Nationwide ranked
- Lawdragon 500 Corporate Employment Lawyers (multiple GT immigration attorneys)

LITIGATION CAPABILITY

Full-service firm with in-house federal litigation and securities enforcement practices; government audit defense and legislative representation documented by Chambers.

CAVEATS

- ! GT is a 2,200+ attorney AmLaw firm — EB-5 investor-side work may be handled by associates with partner oversight rather than senior partner direct involvement; verify staffing before retention.
- ! Higher likely fee ceiling than EB-5 boutiques; fee estimate may exceed client's stated budget depending on scope of securities and Korean-corridor coordination.
- ! Kate Kalmykov's public profile emphasizes corporate immigration compliance over investor-side EB-5 — confirm which partner will lead the I-526E investor file specifically.
- ! As a large firm, conflict checks against regional-center sponsors or their financing parties are more likely to arise — run conflict check early.

VERIFICATION SOURCES

- <https://chambers.com/legal-rankings/immigration-usa-nationwide-5:31:12788:1>
- <https://www.gtlaw.com/en/locations/seoul>
- <https://www.gtlaw.com/en/news/2024/06/press-releases/8-greenberg-traurig-immigration-attorneys-5-regions-included-in-2024-chambers-usa-guide>
- <https://www.eb5insights.com/awards-recognitions/>

Evelyn Hahn (Managing Partner) · Costa Mesa, CA · (949) 441-4003 · www.hirsonimmigration.com

I-526E + I-829 combined representation (estimated) \$14,000–\$26,000

Source: tier estimate — established West Coast EB-5 boutique; quote required

This is the single firmest Korea-corridor match in this search: Evelyn Hahn is a Korean-speaking managing partner who immigrated from South Korea, leads the firm's Korean EB-5 practice, travels to Korea 1–2 times annually for migration-agent conferences, and delivered a publicly documented EB5AN webinar specifically titled "EB-5 Source of Funds: Best Practices for South Korean Nationals" — the most Korea-specific SOF credential identified in this search. David Hirson, the founding partner, is a California State Bar Certified Specialist in Immigration & Nationality Law (continuously since 1990), one of the first attorneys to file EB-5 cases after program inception, former AILA EB-5 Investor Committee Chair, and has documented SOF strategy publications in peer-reviewed EB5 Investors Magazine. The firm represents both individual investors and regional centers, giving dual-lens PPM review capability.

CREDENTIALS (externally verifiable)

- ▢ California State Bar Certified Specialist in Immigration & Nationality Law — David Hirson (continuously since 1990; State Bar of California Board of Legal Specialization)
- ▢ AILA EB-5 Investor Committee Chair (former) — David Hirson; AILA Southern California Chapter Chair (former)
- ▢ Southern California Super Lawyers — David Hirson (multiple years); Evelyn Hahn (2019 Rising Star)
- ▢ AV Preeminent (Martindale-Hubbell) — David Hirson (nearly 20 consecutive years)
- ▢ Best Lawyers in America — David Hirson (2006–2014 confirmed; ongoing)
- ▢ Korean-speaking managing partner (Evelyn Hahn) with documented Korea-specific SOF webinar (EB5AN, publicly available)

LITIGATION CAPABILITY

Immigration litigation capability noted (firm website); AAO arguments documented (David Hirson); less extensive mandamus track record than Klasko or WR

CAVEATS

- ! Smaller firm; Evelyn Hahn carries the Korea practice — confirm she will lead this matter personally given timeline pressure
- ! No published Chambers USA individual ranking for Hahn or current-generation partners; credential depth is thinner than top-tier firms
- ! Super Lawyers listing for Hahn is 2019 (Rising Star, not senior tier) — peer recognition is more limited
- ! Securities-law sophistication for non-TEA PPM review should be verified; confirm relationship with outside securities counsel

VERIFICATION SOURCES

- <https://eb5affiliatenetwork.com/webinar/eb-5-source-of-funds-best-practices-for-south-korean-nationals/>
- <https://www.eb5investors.com/directories/immigration-attorneys/evelyn-hahn/>
- <https://www.eb5investors.com/directories/immigration-attorneys/david-hirson/>
- <https://hirsoneb5.com/about-us-1>
- <https://profiles.superlawyers.com/california/costa-mesa/lawyer/evelyn-hahn/>
- <https://www.hirsonimmigration.com/attorney/hirson-david-esq/>

Case brief used for this search

PURPOSE: EB-5 I-526E — urban TEA-adjacent 2026

VERTICAL: Immigration attorney — EB-5

CASE DESCRIPTION:

EB-5 immigrant-investor petition for a South Korean national investing \$1,050,000 into a regional-center project in a major metropolitan area that did not qualify as a Targeted Employment Area (urban, non-TEA threshold). Investor is currently in the US on an L-1A managerial transfer that expires in 18 months and is using EB-5 to secure a permanent path independent of the L-1 → I-140 multinational executive route, which her current employer has been slow to start.

The matter has three load-bearing dimensions any retained firm must be strong on:

1. Source-of-funds documentation. Capital is sourced from (a) the sale of a tech-services consulting business in Seoul in 2023 (~\$700k after taxes), and (b) liquidation of a long-held domestic

equities portfolio held through a Korean brokerage (~\$350k). Will require Korean tax filings, business-sale closing documents, brokerage statements going back 7+ years, and Bank of Korea reporting to demonstrate compliance with KRW outbound transfer rules.

2. Regional-center due diligence on a non-TEA project. The selected RC project is a mixed-use commercial real-estate development. Counsel needs to evaluate the PPM, escrow release conditions, the \$1.05M (non-TEA) investment threshold, the business plan's job-creation methodology under the post-RIA framework, and the sponsor's track record on prior project I-829 outcomes. Securities counsel coordination expected.
3. Status-bridging strategy. With L-1 expiring in 18 months, counsel must advise on: (a) whether to apply for adjustment of status concurrently with I-526E once a visa number is available, (b) risks of L-1 expiring before I-526E approval given current processing times, and (c) whether to switch to a different nonimmigrant status (E-2, O-1) as a bridge if EB-5 lags.

Preferences:

- Firms with documented EB-5 + Korea-corridor practice; Korean-speaking partner-level attorneys strongly preferred
- East Coast or West Coast US presence acceptable
- Securities-law sophistication (in-house or via trusted outside counsel) – this is non-TEA RC, so PPM review is critical
- Budget: \$30,000–\$50,000 for I-526E + I-829 representation; separate billing for status-bridging work acceptable
- Timeline: petition prep within next 60 days; status bridge may need to start sooner